School Closure Report

Beach Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

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501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Beach Elementary School

Administrator
Niki Johnson

Location
1710 N Humboldt St., Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Beach Elementary School is a K–5 school offering English neighborhood classes and Spanish Dual Language Immersion in the Overlook neighborhood. It emphasizes culturally affirming, rigorous instruction in a nurturing and inclusive environment. Beach was built in 1928 and the campus consists of a two-story school building with a ground floor basement, a detached classroom building, and an L-shaped portable. Approximately 280 students are enrolled at Beach for the 2026-2027 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2027-2028 school year is: $16,958.

If the school is closed in 2027, the projected overall savings is $957,658. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities, and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

Under the proposed change, 40% of students would live more than one mile from Chief Joseph and would be offered school bus transportation. To accommodate all eligible students, PPS anticipates maintaining service to Chief Joseph with three buses. The Transportation Department estimates an additional savings of approximately $105,000. The proposed change would reduce the total number of buses serving the closing and receiving schools, resulting in transportation cost savings.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	284	288	291	297	287

History of Requested and Actual Transfers
During the 2024-2025, 2025-2026, and 2026-2027 school years, 323 students requested transfers into Beach E.S., and 66 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 136 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 39 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer."

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built	Building size	Stories	Acres
1928	70,498 sq ft	3	5.23
Building condition	**Gross capacity**	**Functional capacity**	**Cost of school operations**
Poor; FCI 0.17	774 students	607 students	$4,895,684

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine

staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
The campus includes a main brick-clad concrete school and a detached classroom building. Previous facility assessments identified aging plumbing, heating, ventilation, fire-suppression, and electrical systems; deteriorating roofs, windows, and pavement; and a reported rodent issue. Additional internal assessments also identified undersized classrooms and gym space, and major roof and structural repair needs.

ADA Accessibility
The first floor is accessible through a main entrance and there is an elevator that provides access to the basement and second-floor classrooms.

Building Use
Currently, Beach houses neighborhood K–5 classes and a Spanish Dual Language Immersion program.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Beach facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Beach would reassign neighborhood K–5 students to Chief Joseph and relocate Spanish DLI to César Chávez K–5. Special Education students receiving Learning Center support would continue to receive support at Chief Joseph. Chief Joseph's location relative to the combined attendance area makes it more centrally located and its available space and recent bond improvements provide better building conditions. In addition, a consolidated Spanish language learning community at César Chávez will offer a robust immersion program for students and opportunity for ongoing staff collaboration.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional busing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Chief Joseph Elementary has 17 regular classrooms (and two modular classrooms) and a functional capacity of 444. With a combined enrollment of 440 in 2027/2028, Chief Joseph will be able to fully accommodate the reassigned students and have space for future enrollment fluctuations, if needed. César Chávez K–5 has 29 regular classrooms (and two modular classrooms) and a functional capacity of 564 students. With a combined enrollment of 541, César Chávez K–5 will be able to accommodate the reassigned Spanish DLI students.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Beach School for the 2027–2028 school year, assigning neighborhood K–5 students to Chief Joseph, and relocating Beach's Spanish Dual Language Immersion program to César Chávez K–5.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?
In the 2026-27 school year Portland Public Schools staffs and supports 56 elementary programs across the district. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. The enrollment of these programs ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of "well-resourced schools" as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can stabilize and offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. Given our current and projected budget shortfalls, we can no longer sustain subsidies for underenrolled sites. As a result, elementary schools have already faced several programmatic and operational constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;

- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;
- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in the 2027-2028 school years.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Chief Joseph Elementary School within the Roosevelt cluster. Enrollment at Chief Joseph is projected to change from 242 to 440 in the 2027–2028 school year. Based on current enrollment projections, there will be two to four classrooms at each grade-level, with blends not required. These changes would support a combined neighborhood elementary school community, with opportunities to stabilize staffing and sustain educational programs and student supports. Implementation would require coordinated staffing, classroom assignments, and use of shared spaces to accommodate incoming students while supporting students already enrolled. Chief Joseph is ready to receive new students with minimal kitchen upgrades needed, sufficient instructional and student support spaces, and coordination of school-based partnerships and services.

Beach is located approximately 1.3 miles from Chief Joseph. Nearby community resources include Arbor Lodge Park and its accessible Harper's Playground. The proposed change would shift neighborhood students' daily school activities toward Chief Joseph and Arbor Lodge Park. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for eligible students. PPS would support school bus service for students who live more than one mile from the school and work with the school community and the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Beach does not have Racial Equity & Social Justice (RESJ) partner programming. Closure is not expected to affect RESJ partner services. PPS will continue working with building leaders and school communities at receiving schools so that partnerships reflect what students and families need. Future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process

Beach partners with the YMCA to provide child care for approximately 42 students. Relocating students to Chief Joseph and César Chávez will require a clear plan to maintain access to care. Chief Joseph currently partners with Neighborhood House, serving approximately 45 students, while César Chávez transports approximately 10–15 students to Astor for child care. We ask that the YMCA, Neighborhood House, Chief Joseph, César Chávez, and Astor be included in early transition planning to determine how many students will need care at each location, assess available space and program capacity, and explore opportunities to continue existing provider relationships. This should include evaluating whether Neighborhood House can accommodate additional students, whether César Chávez can offer on-site child care, and whether transportation to Astor can support increased demand. Families need reliable child care options, clear communication, and minimal disruption to established caregiver relationships and routines. A successful transition requires ensuring that all Beach students

who need care have access to safe, dependable, and appropriately supported child care arrangements.

Beach partners with Self Enhancement, Inc. (SEI) to operate its SUN Community School, providing community-based services and wraparound family supports through collaboration among PPS, Multnomah County, and the City of Portland. SUN provides free extended-day enrichment opportunities, quality instruction and extracurricular activities, access to food pantries and other basic-needs resources, and culturally relevant programming supported by staff who reflect and understand the student population. Through SUN, students and families also have connections to food, housing, utility assistance, health and mental health services, family activities, and other community resources. SUN serves as an important point of connection for families seeking individualized support, enrichment opportunities, and assistance navigating services beyond the school day. Closure could disrupt students' access to established relationships with SEI staff, after-school programming, enrichment providers, and basic-needs resources, while requiring families to navigate new service locations and referral processes. These changes may be particularly significant for families who rely on SUN as an accessible connection to food assistance, housing and utility resources, and other wraparound supports. Opportunities for partnerships to continue include transitioning students to Chief Joseph and César Chávez. César Chávez operates a SUN Community School through Latino Network, creating an opportunity for students to continue accessing SUN services, although the transition would involve a change in lead agency from SEI to Latino Network. This change may require families to establish new relationships with SUN staff and navigate different community partnerships, programming, and family-support coordination. Chief Joseph does not operate a SUN Community School, meaning students transitioning there would not have equivalent access to the established SUN service system at their receiving school.

Services requiring further coordination include assessing César Chávez's capacity to accommodate additional students and service needs, identifying which existing SEI partnerships and enrichment opportunities could continue, coordinating the transfer of family referrals and individualized support needs, and identifying alternative providers or referral pathways for students transitioning to Chief Joseph. Particular attention should be given to maintaining access to food assistance, housing and utility resources, health and mental health referrals, and other supports that families may currently access through SUN. Additional community impacts include the potential loss of a trusted neighborhood connection point for families, reduced access to free after-school enrichment and wraparound services for students attending Chief Joseph, and disruption to established relationships with SEI staff and community partners. Proposed responses include coordinating with SEI, Latino Network, and receiving-school leadership to develop a transition plan, establish warm handoffs for students and families moving to César Chávez, identify alternative community-based resources for families transitioning to Chief Joseph, assess staffing and service capacity, and communicate changes in programming and resource access.

Any future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2027, with students assigned to Chief Joseph Elementary School under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2027	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share principal assignments with communities.
February 2027	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2027	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2027	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2027	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2027	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2027	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2027	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2027	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

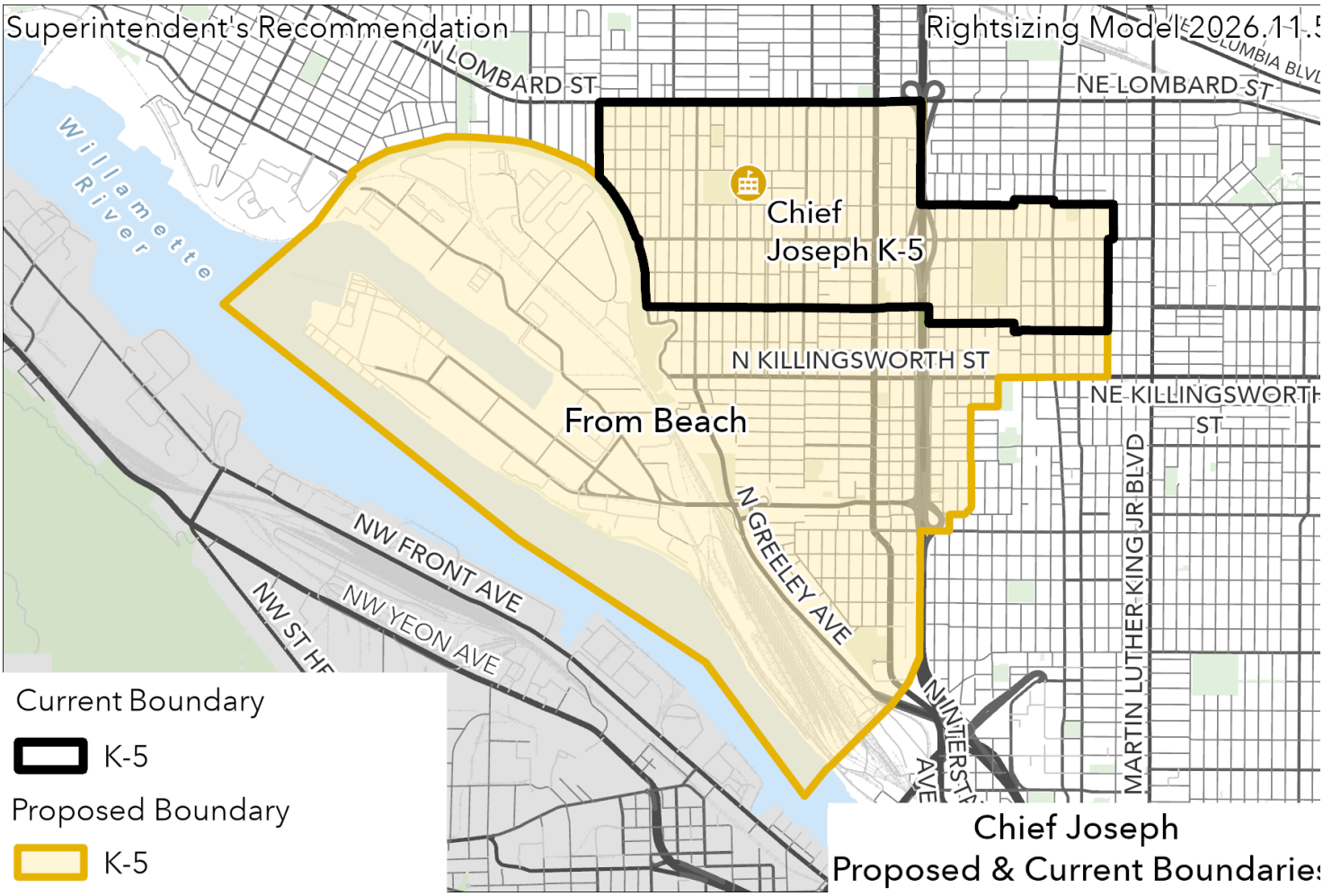
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


Superintendent's Recommendation
Rightsizing Model 2026.11.5
N LOMBARD ST
NE LOMBARD ST
Willamette River
Chief Joseph K-5
N KILLINGSWORTH ST
NE KILLINGSWORTH ST
From Beach
N GREELEY AVE
NW FRONT AVE
NW YEON AVE
MARTIN LUTHER KING JR BLVD
Current Boundary
K-5
Proposed Boundary
K-5
Chief Joseph
Proposed & Current Boundaries